

How to Puppy Proof Your Home

By: Chaz Wilke - Staff Writer



There comes a point after you've committed to rescuing a pup that you realize just how unsafe your home might be to your four legged friend. The realization doesn't come instantly. You think your new rescued pup will settle in perfectly. Your home, after all, is a cozy and welcoming place...

...For humans.

Once you dig into what it might be like for a dog to roam freely in your home, you might start thinking differently. What breakables are on your coffee table? What about power cords? Are there any of those lying around? Do you think a pup might get into something he shouldn't if he was left alone in your living room for any stretch of time?

Deciding on rescuing that puppy likely required a lot of thought and planning. It's expensive to have a dog, but consider the cost and brain space of nesting, or puppy proofing, your home before you bring home Fido. He might just thank you for it later.

Plants

(<https://solarmehome.com/?cid=28806>)

(<https://pursuemortgage.com/?cid=28806>)



In total, there are more than 700 types of plants that are toxic or harmful to your pup if ingested. The number drops considerably when looking only at indoor house plants, but there are still many. So while you might have never considered that Asparagus Fern (<http://bit.ly/1gmtgNd>) you keep in your foyer to be anything but a delightful splash of color, it may be time to send it out to pasture.

Vet Street provides (<http://bit.ly/1M6YYcP>) a comprehensive breakdown of 12 common house plants and what specifically about them is toxic to dogs, and the symptoms to look for if you suspect your pooch has taken a bite.

Garbage



Bedside and bathroom garbage cans don't appear all too appetizing to your human contemporaries, but for a furry four-legged friend that brimming bathroom wastebasket might be too tantalizing to ignore. Avoid leaving garbage out in the open if possible. When that isn't possible, be sure to invest in a can with a lid (<http://amzn.to/1iJycC>).

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If your pup swallows something large or indigestible, there is a chance that he might require surgery to have it removed. If you spot him eating something and you aren't quick enough to snatch it out of his mouth, the waiting game begins. Dogs give clear signals when they are in digestive distress. Watch their tail, watch their activity levels. If your dog becomes lethargic or unresponsive, take them to a vet immediately.

Of course, there always is a chance that they will pass the item in their stool. As a proud puppy parent, it's your job to watch that too. It's just one of the joys of having a fur baby.

Cords

Depending on the age of your rescued pup, you may still be dealing with a dog in the puppy stage. This means anything and everything is fair game for the pup to chew. This is not to say you should let them, but it will be hard to monitor the pup every second of every day for up to the two years (<http://bit.ly/1NzrJ5d>) that the puppy stage can last.

This means you need to think smart about how you hide your cabling. Keeping the cabling tucked behind tables, couches and beds help. But that still won't secure the cable connection points, like on a power strip, so it's your job to contain those in a housing that prevents nosy pups from infiltrating.

You can buy all-weather plastic boxes that are specially designed to contain connection points of power cables. These boxes (<http://amzn.to/1EYaFmN>) are large enough to contain a power strip yet small enough to slide under a couch.

Keep your cables as tucked away as possible, and lock up the connection points to gain a sliver of peace of mind when raising that puppy.

Bedding

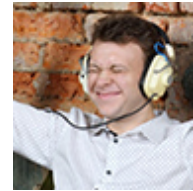


Puppies love to sleep almost as much as they love to play. You'll quickly learn that your entire home is one big bed for your dog. Be ready with blankets, towels, and puppy beds so Fido has locations in each room he knows is his special place to plop down for a quick nap.



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We all dream of finding the perfect home. We obsess over the number of bedrooms, being close to good schools, and a



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Few things are permanent in this disposable culture of ours. But it's still hard to believe how quickly to-



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There is no more potent image of American prosperity than a sprawling tree-lined street filled with large single-family homes. In a word: suburbia - born...

Designating a space in each room helps prevent the pup from taking ownership of a spot that might get damaged from chewing. As you recall, pups love to chew. So let them have a place where they feel safe and comfortable to do just that. This will help keep any chair or couch at least partially safe from the ravages of your pup's unquenchable desire to chew.

Takeaway



It may not seem evident, but dogs instinctually wish to please you. It's been said that there is no bad dog, just bad owners. If the new addition to your family is acting out, it may help to consider what you could do differently to curb the undesired activity.

In the end, some of your stuff will get dirty, or chewed, or straight up ruined. It is important not to get angry at your pup for something he might not even understand is a bad activity. Positive reinforcement works exponentially better than shouting negativity at your dog.

It is your job as a new dog owner to provide a safe and calm environment for your new pooch. Cover his basic needs and make him feel loved. This simple act will be returned tenfold in the years to come!

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